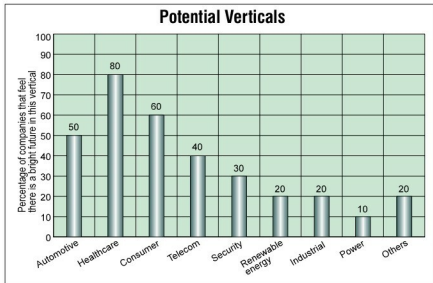


fresh graduates from top engineering colleges. Xilinx has excellent training and development programmes that help young engineers acquire critical job skills. In addition, we are actively engaged with leading engineering institutions in India (e.g., IITs and IISc, Bengaluru) to provide access to Xilinx' full suite of FPGA design tools and hardware development boards for teaching and research, and we foster an ongoing exchange of best practices between Indian academia and universities around the world."

A majority of the companies interviewed offered a salary package between Rs 450,000 and Rs 750,000 per annum for engineering undergraduates and Rs 850,000 per annum for graduates. Understandably, some companies preferred not to reveal their salary package figures.

The IDCs look for various skills while recruiting freshers as they want the best of talent for every vacancy. In the hardware field, they look for electrical and electronics engineers with strong electronics design fundamentals—analogue and digital, VLSI design, VHDL, Verilog, prototyping, system verification, and electronics and system design.

In the software world, they look for engineers with sound knowledge and programming skills in the Linux kernel, C, scripting and embedded



software.

The other skills needed are an aptitude for learning, ability to solve problems, good communication skills, technical soundness, independent attitude, interpersonal skills, good work ethics and general behaviour, and responsible participation in teams.

Varma summed up: "We seek outstanding engineers with a combination of strong technical and leadership skills."

There is a lot of learning in store for recruits. Most of the design companies give at least two months of in-house training to freshers, while some prefer to train recruits on-the-job under capable mentors.

Bright future

Majority of the companies (80 per cent) felt healthcare as the sweetest spot for design houses. The other prospective areas are consumer electronics (60 per cent), telecom (40 per cent) and automotive (50 per cent), followed by renewable energy (20 per cent), industrial (20 per cent) and power (10 per cent) electronics. Some other significant areas include e-governance, cloud computing and multimedia convergence.

The Indian design industry is all set to grow globally. "We see many start-ups and third-party design houses or independent design houses coming up. These companies are now excited about learning and doing R&D for global markets. It is not just a chip; they want to put solutions together—the complete software or system—and want to compete with Delphi, Bosch and other global players. Bengaluru is a great R&D centre. Companies have R&D centres here and they approach us directly to work together and provide a complete ecosystem for developing potentially market-leading products for the global market," said Rajiv Jain.

To be concluded next month

Janani is a technically-qualified freelance writer, editor and hands-on mom based in Bengaluru

Key findings

1. Most work done by IDCs is for telecom and automotive sectors.
2. USA and Europe outsource a lot of design work to India.
3. Recession hit the design industry hard, but it is reviving well, with growth of 20 to 40 per cent.
4. IDCs are faced with the challenge of delivering the best designs and innovating constantly.
5. They co-create with customers, and collaborate with distributors, third-party designers, etc.
6. Low power, optimal cost, high performance, programmability and fast time-to-market are essential for the success of a design.
7. Customers want holistic single-window solutions and not just point solutions.
8. Broad and technologically-rich product portfolios help IDCs to counter competition.
9. Reliability and security are important parameters in judging an IDC.
10. IDCs use events as a very important tool to interface with their markets.
11. Indian design houses do recruit candidates right out of college. Some provide around two months of training while others train on the job.
12. Healthcare is considered by IDCs to be the most lucrative market in the near future.